

4. PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

4.1 Goal of the Project

This project sets out to build and demonstrate a full incident lifecycle in ServiceNow — covering incident logging, classification, knowledge-base use, assignment, escalation, linked incidents, emergency changes, resolution, and SLA checks.

4.2 Plan of Implementation

Activity 1 — Setting Up the Service

Identify or configure the business service / service offering that incidents will be tied to.

Activity 2 — Logging a Sample Incident

Create a test incident with all the required fields populated, and confirm that a ticket number is generated automatically.

Activity 3 — Classifying the Incident

Set the following fields:

- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency
- Priority

Check that the classification applied is correct.

Activity 4 — Assigning the Incident

Route the incident to the correct assignment group and agent.

Activity 5 — Using the Knowledge Base

Look up relevant knowledge articles and apply useful information during troubleshooting.

Activity 6 — Escalating to Level 2

Move the incident to Level 2 support when the first-line team cannot resolve it.

Activity 7 — Raising an Emergency Change

Create an emergency change request where an urgent fix is required, and link it to the incident.

Activity 8 — Creating a Child Incident

Open a child incident for a related issue and confirm the parent-child link holds.

Activity 9 — Resolving the Incident

Close out the troubleshooting work and enter:

- Resolution code
- Resolution notes
- Solution details

Activity 10 — Writing a Knowledge Article

Document the solution as a reusable knowledge article.

Activity 11 — Checking SLA and Related Records

Confirm:

- SLA status
- Child incidents
- Change request
- Knowledge article
- Any other related records

4.3 Resources Needed

Platform

A ServiceNow instance

ServiceNow Modules

- Incident Management
- Knowledge Management
- Change Management
- Service Management
- SLA Management

Users / Roles

- End User
- Service Desk Agent
- Level 2 Agent
- Change Management User
- Knowledge User
- Administrator

4.4 Risks and How They're Mitigated

Risk: Incident misclassified **Mitigation:** Set clear definitions for category, subcategory, impact, and urgency.

Risk: Wrong assignment group used **Mitigation:** Double-check assignment groups before routing an incident.

Risk: SLA target missed **Mitigation:** Watch SLA status closely and escalate on time.

Risk: Duplicate tickets created **Mitigation:** Search for existing incidents before logging related records.

Risk: Resolution notes too thin **Mitigation:** Require clear, complete resolution documentation.

Risk: Wrong change linked to an incident **Mitigation:** Confirm related records before the incident is closed.